



Republic of the Philippines
Province of Pampanga
Municipality of Porac
Barangay Manibaug Paralaya

Barangay Resolution No. _____

A RESOLUTION RECOGNIZING THE MANIBAUG PARALAYA YOUTH PRESS CORPS (MPYPC) AS AN INDEPENDENT YOUTH-LED MEDIA ENTITY AND AFFIRMING ITS AUTONOMY AND CIVIC FUNCTION.

WHEREAS, the Barangay Council of Manibaug Paralaya recognizes the vital role of youth in nation-building and the importance of free and ethical journalism in promoting transparency, civic engagement, and public awareness;

WHEREAS, the Manibaug Paralaya Youth Press Corps (MPYPC) is a youth-led organization composed of residents aged 13–21 committed to nonpartisan and ethical journalism under the ethical standards set by the Philippine Press Institute and other recognized journalism codes of conduct.

WHEREAS, MPYPC seeks to operate free from political, commercial, or governmental interference and asserts its editorial independence in all publications and content decisions;

WHEREAS, this resolution affirms MPYPC's right to exercise independent editorial control, while receiving ceremonial recognition and limited financial assistance as part of youth development efforts;

NOW THEREFORE, on motion of _____, duly seconded by _____, BE IT RESOLVED, AS IT IS HEREBY RESOLVED by the Sangguniang Barangay of Manibaug Paralaya in session duly assembled:

SECTION 1. The Manibaug Paralaya Youth Press Corps (MPYPC) is hereby officially recognized as a youth-led, independent media organization operating within the jurisdiction of Barangay Manibaug Paralaya.

SECTION 2. MPYPC shall retain full editorial independence, defined as the sole authority over content creation, publication, staffing, internal governance, and editorial policy. No government official, barangay officer, or third-party entity shall interfere, influence, or mandate any editorial decision or leadership appointment.

SECTION 3. The Barangay Council may provide financial assistance as part of its youth development efforts, strictly as an unconditional civic grant. No terms, expectations, or performance metrics shall be attached to such funding that affect editorial content or leadership decisions. MPYPC's eligibility for civic funding shall not be contingent upon editorial alignment with Barangay narratives or politics. Retaliatory withholding of funds may be grounds for public disclosure.

a. Funding shall be allocated annually, with a minimum grant equivalent to PHP 30,000 or as determined by the Barangay Council's youth development budget, subject to a transparent application process outlined in the Barangay's administrative guidelines. The minimum grant shall be adjusted every three (3) years based on the Consumer Price Index or as approved by the Barangay Council.

b. If the Barangay Council withholds or denies funding, it shall provide written justification to MPYPC within ten (10) days, specifying budgetary or administrative reasons. Failure to provide justification may be grounds for public disclosure by MPYPC.

c. MPYPC is encouraged to pursue alternative funding sources, such as municipal youth grants or non-governmental organization (NGO) support, to ensure operational continuity independent of Barangay funding.

SECTION 4. The Barangay Press Adviser shall serve as the founder and guardian of the Manibaug Paralaya Youth Press Corps (MPYPC), with the authority to appoint or remove the Editor-in-Chief via signed decree and to override or veto decisions in cases of legal, ethical, or structural violations, or to ensure organizational continuity. While MPYPC retains autonomy from external interference, the Press Adviser's powers are subject to the *Suspensus Potestas* Procedure to ensure checks and balances:

a. In the event of a significant action by the Barangay Press Adviser (e.g., removal of the Editor-in-Chief or veto of editorial decisions), the Editor-in-Chief (EIC) may activate *Suspensus Potestas* via a public proclamation published in MPYPC's official channels, stating the basis for the challenge. This temporarily nullifies the Adviser's powers for five (5) days, during which the EIC shall convene the Associate Editor-in-Chief and Department Heads to determine if the Adviser's action is rational and aligned with MPYPC's governing charter, ethical journalism standards (e.g., Philippine Press Institute codes), and organizational objectives.

b. A majority vote among the Associate Editor-in-Chief and Department Heads is required to override the Adviser's action.

c. If no decision is reached within five (5) days, the Adviser's powers are restored, and the action proceeds. The EIC may request a one-time two (2)-day extension with majority approval.

d. The EIC may call for the removal of the Barangay Press Adviser, requiring a two-thirds (2/3) supermajority of the Editorial Board, defined as the Editor-in-Chief, Associate Editor-in-Chief, Department Heads, and three Ethics Committee members elected by the members of MPYPC, per MPYPC's governing charter.

e. If the Adviser's action is upheld, the EIC may request non-binding mediation from a neutral external body (e.g., a municipal youth council or journalism ethics board).

f. The *Suspensus Potestas* Procedure shall be codified in MPYPC's governing charter to ensure enforceability.

SECTION 5. MPYPC reserves the right to terminate its formal recognition should its editorial autonomy be violated. Editorial autonomy violation is defined as any action, including but not limited to censorship, coerced editorial alignment, or unauthorized interference in leadership appointments, that undermines MPYPC's independent control over content, staffing, or governance.

a. Prior to termination, MPYPC shall initiate a dispute resolution process as outlined in Section 8, seeking mediation with the Barangay Council to address the violation.

b. Upon termination, the Barangay Council shall provide a final funding installment of PHP 30,000, as specified in Section 3(a), to support MPYPC's transition to independent operation.

c. MPYPC may continue to operate as an independent civic entity under Republic Act No. 8044 (Youth in Nation-Building Act) and other applicable Philippine youth organization laws, ensuring legal protections for its activities and governance.

SECTION 6. Any future amendment or repeal of this recognition must be subject to the written concurrence of the Editor-in-Chief of MPYPC and the organization's governing charter, as attached in Annex A. No unilateral action by the Barangay Council shall override this autonomy without the express written consent of the Editor-in-Chief and a two-thirds (2/3) majority of the Editorial Board, defined as the Editor-in-Chief, Associate Editor-in-Chief, Department Heads, and three Ethics Committee members elected by the members of MPYPC, per MPYPC's governing charter. Disputes regarding amendments or repeal shall follow the dispute resolution process in Section 8.

SECTION 7. If any provision of this resolution is held invalid or unconstitutional, the remaining provisions shall remain in full force and effect.

SECTION 8. Dispute Resolution. In the event of conflicts arising from alleged violations of editorial autonomy (Section 5) or disputes over amendments or repeal (Section 6), MPYPC and the Barangay Council shall engage in a dispute resolution process:

a. The aggrieved party shall submit a written complaint to the other party, outlining the issue and proposed resolution.

b. Both parties shall convene within ten (10) days for mediation facilitated by a neutral third party, such as a municipal youth council representative or a recognized journalism ethics body (e.g., Philippine Press Institute affiliate).

c. If mediation fails within thirty (30) days, either party may escalate the matter to arbitration under the rules of the Alternative Dispute Resolution Act of 2004 (Republic Act No. 9285).

d. The dispute resolution process shall not delay or prevent MPYPC from exercising its right to terminate recognition under Section 5, if deemed necessary.

RESOLVED FURTHER, that copies of this resolution be furnished to all relevant offices and institutions for information and appropriate action.

APPROVED this ____ day of _____, 2025 at Barangay Manibaug Paralaya, Porac, Pampanga.

Certified Correct:

JENNIFER B. SANTOS

Barangay Secretary

Annex A: MPYPC Governing Charter,
included as a separate section following this resolution.

Approved:

HON. BENJAMIN Y. PEÑA

Punong Barangay